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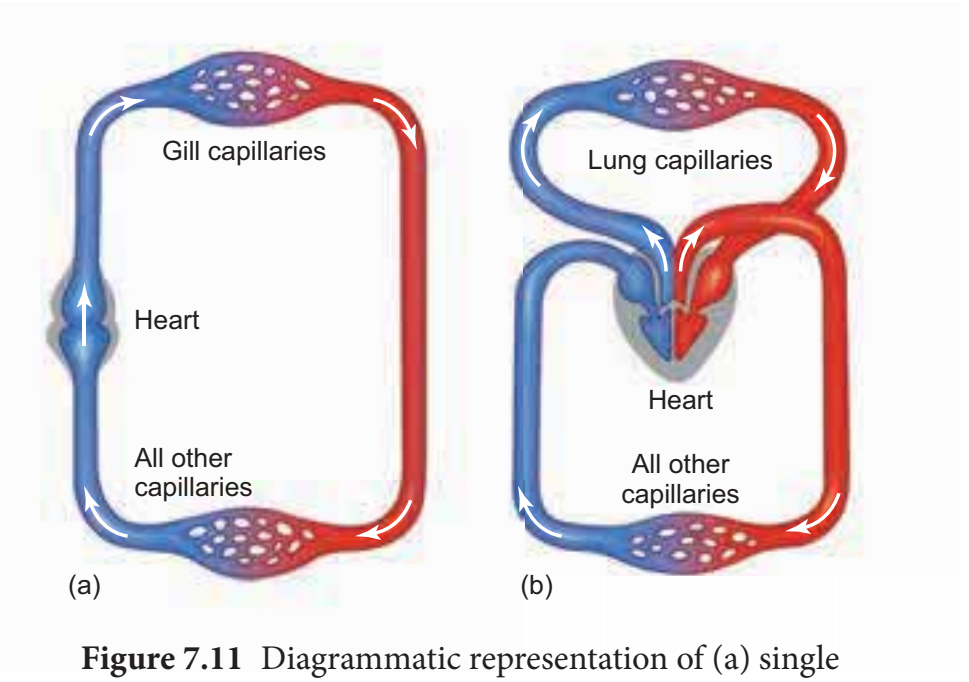


Figure 7.11 Diagrammatic representation of (a) single circulation (b) double circulation

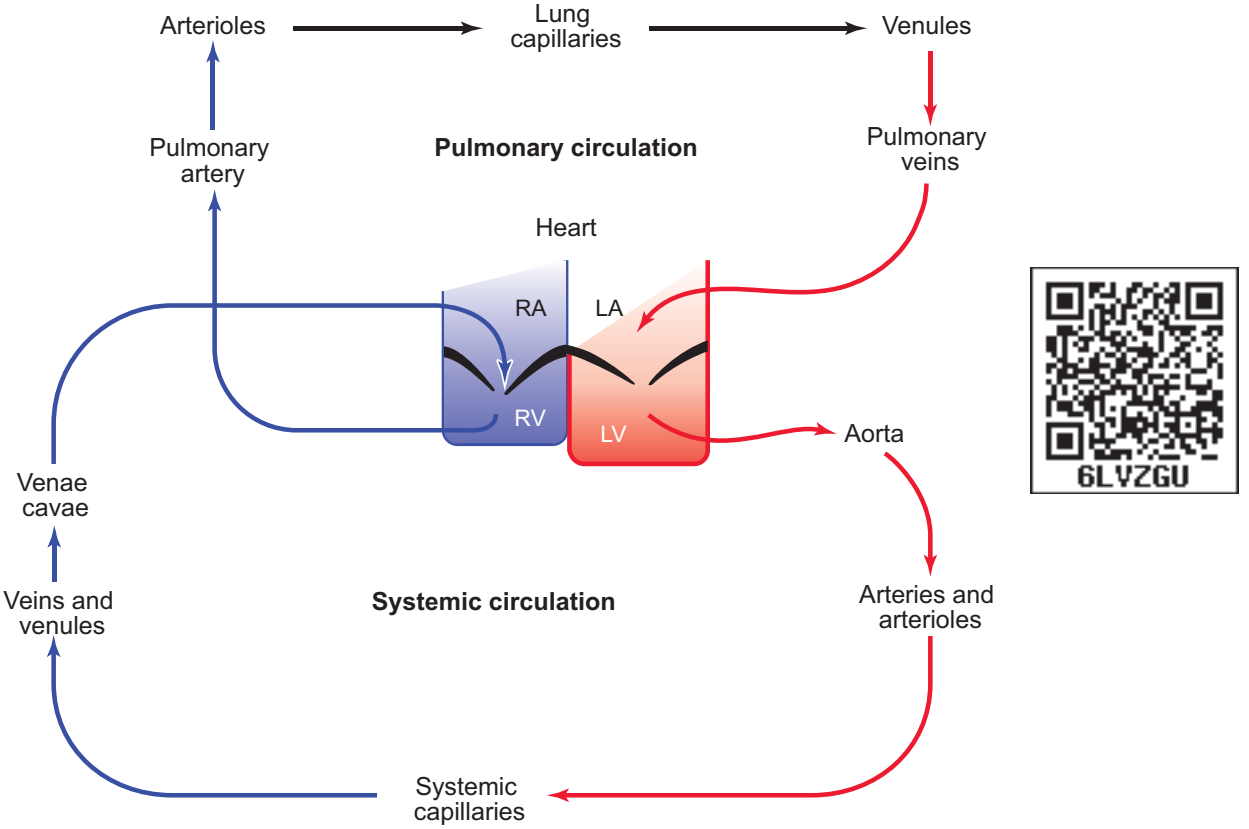


Figure 7.12 Diagrammatic representation of the Double circulation

and systemic circulation. Why is this advantageous? In the lungs the capillaries must be very thin to allow gas exchange, but if the blood flows through these thin capillaries under high pressure the fluid can leak through or ruptures the capillary walls and can accumulate in the tissues. This increases the diffusion distance and reduces the efficiency of the gas exchange. In contrast high pressure